module_a.coffee **module_b.coffee**

exports.y = x

The calls to `require` don't have any file extensions. Why not?

12.1.3. No file extensions

So far, all of the calls to `require` haven't included any of the .coffee file extensions. What happens if you create a `require` statement *with* a file extension?

```
{Controller} = require './controller.coffee'
```

The program runs just fine when invoked as CoffeeScript from the command line. Was there any reason to leave off the file extensions?

```
> coffee blog.coffee
# application is running successfully at http://localhost:8080
```

If you first compile the blog.coffee file and then run it, everything breaks:

```
> coffee –c blog.coffee
> node blog.js
controller.coffee:2
class Controller
^^^^^
...
SyntaxError: Unexpected reserved word
```

Never put the file extension in a `require` statement. A JavaScript program can't `require` a CoffeeScript file without loading the CoffeeScript compiler first. If you leave file extensions *out*, however, then your compiled JavaScript modules can load other compiled JavaScript modules, instead of trying to load CoffeeScript files. The source for a module is in a file, but you don't think of it as requiring the file itself but as requiring the module it contains. There's another good reason for thinking this way: modules are cached.